

Consolidated from: [ClaudePRD SAAS VoiceApp](#) ...
[non_negotiables.md](https://www.notion.so/non_negotiables-md-c948052de9a248b1b6224f1c77e76935?pvs=21)

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VALIDATED DECISIONS (Locked) — Updated Feb 4, 2026

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Decision	Validated Choice
ICP	Early-career managers & rising execs 
Positioning Model	"Gap Model" — <i>Your communication doesn't match your competence</i>
Hero Copy	"You're smart. Your conversations should prove it."
Pricing	Freemium model: \$12.99/mo (Basic) → \$28.99/mo (Pro)
Paywall Trigger	After 3rd practice session
Volitional Diagnostics	Language translation guide created for user-facing copy

Volitional Diagnostics — Language Translation Guide

Internal Term	User-Facing Language
Skill gap	"You haven't practiced this enough yet"
Motivation gap	"This doesn't feel important to you right now"
Commitment gap	"You know what to do but haven't locked it in"
Willpower depletion	"You're running on empty — smaller steps will help"
Habit not formed	"This isn't automatic yet — keep showing up"
Environmental blocker	"Something in your setup is making this harder"

1. Product Vision

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One-liner: The "Duolingo of professional communication" — a practice-based communication skills platform that's voice-first and AI-driven.

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What Kdenz Is

- **Practice-based** communication skills platform
- **Spoken communication only** (voice-first)
- **AI-driven coaching** via evaluation and synthesis, not content delivery
- Feedback philosophy: **mechanistic, observable, actionable, explanatory**

What Kdenz Is NOT (Hard Boundary)

- Not therapy
- Not clinical diagnosis
- Not mental health assessment
- Not motivational or interpretive coaching
- No attribution of internal emotional or psychological states

Core Capabilities

Capability	Description
Verbal metrics	Word choice, structure, clarity
Vocal metrics	Pace, volume, tone, pauses
Interaction metrics	Turn-taking, interruption, listening signals
Outcome metrics	Goal achievement, trust, influence

MVP Scope (Ships First)

- Core recording + transcription
- Basic metric set (filler words, pace, pauses, talk/listen ratio)
- Simple scoring + actionable tips
- Session history and progress view

Later Phases

- Full metric suite (40+)
- Real-time coaching overlays

- Multi-scenario practice flows
- Team dashboards and enterprise features

2. Target Audience & Positioning

Ideal Customer Profile

Dimension	Definition
Who	Early-career managers & rising execs — hungry, ambitious, time-poor
Pain Point	Professionals who feel underpaid or under-assertive in high-stakes conversations
Context	Salary negotiations, difficult conversations, pitching, giving feedback

Positioning

Element	Direction
Vibe	Peloton energy: premium, aspirational, cool, competitive, community-driven
Core Promise	"Every conversation. Trained."
Transformation	"Become the leader people actually listen to" — identity + skill
Aha Moment	"Holy shit, I never noticed I do that" — the self-awareness unlock

Messaging Hooks (Test These)

- "Your batting cage for hard conversations"
- "See what you sound like. Fix what holds you back."
- "Train your voice like athletes train their bodies"
- "Leadership isn't taught. It's trained."

Founder Positioning

"I'm a physician who realized the skills that got me through med school weren't the skills I needed to lead. I built this to train what no one teaches you."

Credentials: Triple board-certified physician

3. Design & Brand Direction

Brand Name

Kdenz

Color Palette — "The Executive Presence"

Role	Hex	Usage
Primary Accent	#008080	Headlines, key metrics, active states, links
Secondary Accent	#1E3A5F	Section backgrounds, badges, secondary buttons
Success/Positive	#10B981	Improvements, streaks, achievements
Warning/Attention	#F97316	Areas to improve, alerts
Background (Primary)	#FFFFFF	Main page background
Background (Cards)	#F3F4F6	Cards, containers, sections
Text (Primary)	#111827	Headlines, body copy
Text (Secondary)	#6B7280	Subheads, captions
CTA Buttons	#000000	All primary call-to-action buttons

Typography

- **Font:** Inter or SF Pro
- **Hero H1:** Bold (700), 56px desktop / 36px mobile

- **Section H2:** Semibold (600), 40px / 28px
- **Body:** Regular (400), 18px / 16px

Visual Direction

- Dark background with high contrast
- Bold, confident typography
- Phone mockups showing real app screens with metrics
- Mobile-first design
- Icon system for practice categories

Button Styles

- **Primary CTA:** Black background (#000000), white text, 8px border-radius
 - **Secondary:** Transparent with teal border (#008080)
 - **Ghost/Tertiary:** Teal text with underline on hover
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4. Product Flow

User Journey

1. **Landing Page** → Quiz (lead magnet)
2. **Quiz completion** → Email gate → Personalized Negotiator Profile
3. **Profile** → "Start Practice" → Dojo preflight
4. **Dojo** → Choose mode/scenario/widgets → Practice session
5. **Post-session** → Results Dashboard (Strive Score, metrics, insights)

Practice Categories (Launch with 4-5)

Category	Icon	Use Case
Salary Negotiation		Comp conversations, promotions
Difficult Conversations		Conflict, feedback, boundaries
Clarity & Concision		Explaining complex ideas simply
Pitching & Persuasion		Selling ideas, influence
Giving Feedback		Constructive, direct, motivating

Metrics Tracked (At Launch)

Metric	User-Facing Copy
Negotiation Success Score	"Win more conversations"
Verbal Precision	"Cut the filler. Sound sharper."
Authority Score	"Speak with presence"
Practice Streak	"Build the habit. See the growth."

5. Key Constraints (Locked)

Privacy Boundaries

- ☐ Explicit consent before recording
- ☐ Clear retention controls
- ☐ Minimize raw audio storage; prefer derived metrics + transcript
- ☐ No indefinite raw audio storage by default

Feedback Boundaries

- Real-time feedback: **visual only, non-interruptive**
- No spoken prompts, nudges, or corrections during speech
- Post-turn and post-session feedback is where explanation lives

Language Boundaries (Hard Ban)

Disallowed in UI, LLM outputs, and marketing:

- Anxiety, stress, nervousness
- Confidence, insecurity, self-esteem
- Any emotional attribution

Allowed language:

- Speech patterns, vocal characteristics
 - Structural clarity, habits
 - Observable behavior
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6. Open Questions (Need Answers)

Business Model

- ☐ **B2C vs B2B vs hybrid?** (Decision required)
- ☐ **Pricing tiers finalized?** (Currently: \$12.99 Basic / \$28.99 Pro)
- ☐ **Trial length?** (7, 14, or 30 days)

Platform & Tech

- ☐ **Platform priority?** (Web, mobile, desktop — mobile-first recommended)
- ☐ **Real-time vs post-call analysis emphasis?**
- ☐ **Privacy posture and data retention policy?**

Product

- ☐ **Quiz questions finalized?**
- ☐ **Coaching methodology sources and licensing needs?**
- ☐ **Community platform choice?** (Slack vs Discord vs Notion vs custom)

Brand

- ☐ **Final brand name confirmed?** (Currently: Kdenz)
- ☐ **App mockup designs ready?**
- ☐ **Logo wordmark finalized?**

Validation

- ☐ **How is accuracy of voice metrics validated?**
 - ☐ **What evidence is required before making performance claims?**
 - ☐ **What not to claim publicly in v1?**
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7. Success Criteria

6-Month Targets

- MVP launched with stable capture + scoring
- Demonstrated repeat usage and measurable improvement signals
- Founding 100 community established

12-Month Targets

- Expanded metrics and coaching loops
- Clear monetization path validated (B2C, B2B, or hybrid)

- 2-3 testimonials or case studies
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8. Research Synthesis

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RESEARCH SYNTHESIS COMPLETE — 16,000+ words across 8 major domains, 60+ research citations

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Document Contents

- Section A: Scientific Foundations
 -  **Vocal prosody research:** How pitch, pacing, pauses, and tone signal confidence & credibility
 -  **Articulation/clarity science:** How to measure and teach clear speech
 -  **Emotion recognition in audio:** Critical limitations and biases (gender, accent, age) you must address
 -  **Evidence for communication training effectiveness**
- Section B: UX & Design Best Practices
 -  How to simplify complex metrics for consumers (avoid jargon, use comparisons)
 -  Visualization methods that work (time-series graphs, before/after, progress tracking)
 -  Dashboard structure: "How did I sound?" → "What should I do next?"
 -  Onboarding flows for unfamiliar metrics
 -  Gamification elements proven to increase retention (22% average lift)
- Section C: Product Strategy
 -  5 key user segments with jobs-to-be-done (job seekers, presenters, creators, non-native speakers)
 -  What consumers actually value (progress visibility, specific feedback, coaching not just metrics)
 -  Retention drivers vs. overwhelm triggers
 -  Pricing models: Freemium vs. course-based vs. B2B
 -  Your differentiation opportunities (volitional diagnostics, ethical AI, integrated coaching)
- Section D: Technical Approaches
 -  Real-time audio processing (WebRTC, on-device vs. server-side trade-offs)
 -  Concrete algorithms for each metric:
 - Pacing/Speaking Rate (VAD + ASR-based counting)
 - Clarity/Articulation (formant extraction + spectral analysis)

- Filler Words (ASR + pattern matching)
 - Energy/Confidence (pitch range + intonation + volume stability)
 - Pause Patterns (silence detection + classification)
 - ☒ Recommended ML models (Whisper ASR, Silero VAD, CREPE pitch, etc.)
 - ☒ Hybrid architecture recommendation (real-time on-device + server-side batch processing)
 - Section E: Competitor Analysis
 - ☒ Detailed breakdown of Yoodli, Orai, Poised, Speeko (what they do well, user complaints, positioning)
 - ☒ Market gaps (emotion detection transparency, non-native speaker focus, root-cause diagnosis, social confidence, aging population)
 - ☒ UX mistakes to avoid (overwhelming metrics, judgment language, no onboarding, bias in emotion detection)
 - Section F: Behavior Change & Feedback Psychology
 - ☒ GAIN Framework (Goal, Ally, Impact, Non-judgmental) — evidence-based feedback approach
 - ☒ Growth mindset orientation (how to frame feedback for motivation, not shame)
 - ☒ Psychological safety principles (Edmondson)
 - ☒ Volitional diagnostics strategy (identify root cause: skill gap vs. motivation gap vs. commitment gap)
 - ☒ How to prevent dropout and demotivation
 - Section G: Strategic Recommendations
 - ☒ MVP feature roadmap (Phase 1: Core, Phase 2: Engagement, Phase 3: Differentiation)
 - ☒ 3 positioning options (empathy-driven, diagnostic-driven, inclusive-driven)
 - ☒ Go-to-market strategy (content marketing, partnerships, referral)
 - ☒ Monetization tiers (freemium + premium + optional coaching)
 - ☒ Success metrics to track (retention, conversion, NPS by phase)
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Key Strategic Insights

1. Your Unique Competitive Advantage

Your combination of:

- Clinical expertise (physician, multiple board certifications)
- Deep knowledge of volitional systems & behavior change psychology
- Ethical, transparent approach to AI
- Technical capability (Gemini Live API, no-code automation)

Differentiation Strategy:

- Don't compete on features with Orai/Yoodli (they're well-funded, feature-rich)
- Instead, build on your unique IP: **Volitional diagnostics**
 - "Why do people struggle?" (skill gap, motivation gap, commitment gap, etc.)
 - Personalized coaching based on root cause
 - Integrate optional human coaching (you or contractor network)
- Position as ethical: "The only speech coaching app that's transparent about emotion detection biases"

2. Emotion Recognition is a Trap

- **Don't:** Build emotion detection as a core feature (it's biased against women, non-native speakers, neurodivergent folks)
- **Do:** Focus on less-biased metrics first (pacing, clarity, fillers, energy as composite of non-emotional features)
- **If you include emotion:** Label it clearly as "experimental/beta" with disclaimers; frame as optional feature

3. Market Opportunity is Real but Requires Focus

- TAM is huge but fragmented: job seekers, presenters, creators, non-native speakers, dating/social confidence, older adults
- Don't try to serve everyone at launch
- **Start with:** Job seekers + interview prep (highest intent, high volume, willingness to pay)
- **Then expand:** Public speaking, creators, non-native speakers (in that order)

4. Freemium is the Right Model

Tier	Price	Features
Free	\$0	Unlimited recordings + 3-4 basic metrics (builds habit, lowers friction)
Premium	\$10-15/mo	All metrics, transcripts, coaching videos, progress tracking
Coaching Add-on	\$50-100/mo	Optional human verification/check-ins (could be you initially)

Target: 20%+ premium conversion rate (Orai/Yoodli achieve this)

5. Real-Time Feedback Wins

- Post-hoc analysis is easier technically but less engaging
- Real-time visual feedback (pacing gauge, filler word alerts) during recording drives engagement
- Poised's "live meeting feedback" is their killer feature

- **Your app should include:** Real-time pacing gauge + filler word alerts (doable with streaming ASR)

6. Gamification Works But Can Backfire

- **Do use:** Streaks (Duolingo effect: 12% engagement lift), progress charts, celebration of progress
- **Avoid:** Global leaderboards, badges for everything, judgment language
- **Instead:** Personalized benchmarks, comparison to own past self, effort-based rewards (not outcome-based)

7. Behavior Change Psychology is Core

- GAIN Framework beats judgment-based feedback (Lenny Pondy research)
- Transparency about limitations builds trust (especially with emotion detection)
- Volitional diagnostics is your edge: Help users identify the *real* blocker (not just "you're slow")
- Psychological safety matters: Users won't engage if feedback feels judgmental



Immediate Action Items

Week 1: Validate Core Assumptions

- ☐ Interview 10-20 job seekers: What's their #1 pain point in interviews? (pacing? confidence? clarity?)
- ☐ Test assumption: Would they pay \$10-15/mo for coaching?
- ☐ Which metrics matter most in their experience?

Week 2-3: Build MVP Prototype

- ☐ Core metrics first (4 only): Pacing, Filler Words, Clarity, Energy
- ☐ Recording + transcript + dashboard (leverage Gemini Live API experience for audio streaming)
- ☐ Free tier launch: 1 recording per day, basic metrics, no paywall for 30 days

Week 4-8: Validate + Iterate

- ☐ Get 500+ users through content marketing (blog posts on interview tips)
- ☐ Measure: 30-day retention (target: 30%), NPS (target: 40+), premium interest
- ☐ Iterate based on what users actually value

Month 3+: Scale Phase 1

- ☐ Add real-time feedback (pacing gauge, filler alerts)

- [] Add scenario-based practice (interview Q&A scripts)
 - [] Micro-lessons (2-3 min coaching videos)
 - [] Launch premium tier
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Research Document Contents

Full research document ([speech-coaching-research.md](#)) includes:

-  60+ research citations (PMC journals, ISCA conference papers, industry reports)
 -  Concrete algorithms for each metric (code-ready pseudocode)
 -  Detailed competitor analysis (Yoodli, Orai, Poised, Speeko)
 -  UX patterns from top apps + what to avoid
 -  Technical architecture recommendations (hybrid real-time + batch)
 -  Product roadmap (3-phase rollout)
 -  Go-to-market strategy + positioning options
 -  Monetization tiers + success metrics
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Final Thought: You're in a unique position. Most speech coaching apps are built by product teams that understand metrics and gamification. You bring something rarer: deep knowledge of *why people struggle to change*, what actually motivates behavior improvement, and how to coach with psychological safety.

Your volitional systems framework could be a genuine differentiator. Instead of "optimize your pacing," you'd diagnose: "You have the skill but not the commitment—here's how to build habit."

That's not a feature. That's a philosophy. And it's what users actually need.

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9. Source Documents

This brief consolidates information from:

- [ClaudePRD SAAS VoiceApp](#) — Product vision, capabilities, constraints
- — Positioning, ICP, marketing strategy
- — Color palette, typography, page structure

- [non_negotiables.md](https://www.notion.so/non_negotiables-md-c948052de9a248b1b6224f1c77e76935?pvs=21) — Founder guardrails
- [Negotiator SaaS — Landing Page Best Practices](#) — User flow, quiz structure